



RED BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident	31 January 2024	Time of Incident	14:38
Directorate / Region	RMO – Great Southern Region	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	37362
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate

Incident Short Description	Traffic Controller reversed into culvert and rolled onto side.
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What Happened

A panel contract traffic control contractor was tasked with reporting defects and removing dead wildlife on the network whilst routine maintenance was otherwise occupied. The driver and a single passenger left the depot at 06:00, travelling the network all day in a light vehicle (LV) spotting defects and attending aftercare signage. On the return route to the depot in the afternoon, the driver observed a shove at SLK 9.0 on M001 and pulled onto the shoulder to better assess the defect.

The driver reversed the LV back along the shoulder not realising they had just passed a culvert post, and there was a culvert head wall behind the vehicle. When reversing, the right (driver side) wheel has remained at road level while the left (passenger side) rear wheel has tracked into the void of the culvert wall.

The vehicle was travelling slowly and stopped once the left rear wheel entered the void. Due to the difference in height right to left, the vehicle has become unstable/unbalanced and rolled, coming to rest on the left-hand side. The driver and passenger held the door pillar handles as the vehicle tipped. The driver and passenger exited the vehicle through the driver's window. Neither driver nor passenger sustained an obvious injury.

The passenger called their supervisor and they promptly advised Main Roads – both parties responded and attended the scene. Initial assistance was provided by a Member of Public (MOP) to reassure the driver and passenger. Driver and passenger were taken to hospital and assessed for injuries.

The driver experienced shock post-incident and was advised to refrain from attending work for one day, resulting in a lost time injury (LTI); the driver returned to work on 2 February 2024.



Vehicle position after the incident.

A formal investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to **Vehicles and Driving**

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations